Week 6: MENTAL MAPPING

Different people experience the same spaces in different ways. But how? and why? Through what mechanisms? Can we represent/map these different experiences? What does this tell us about power?

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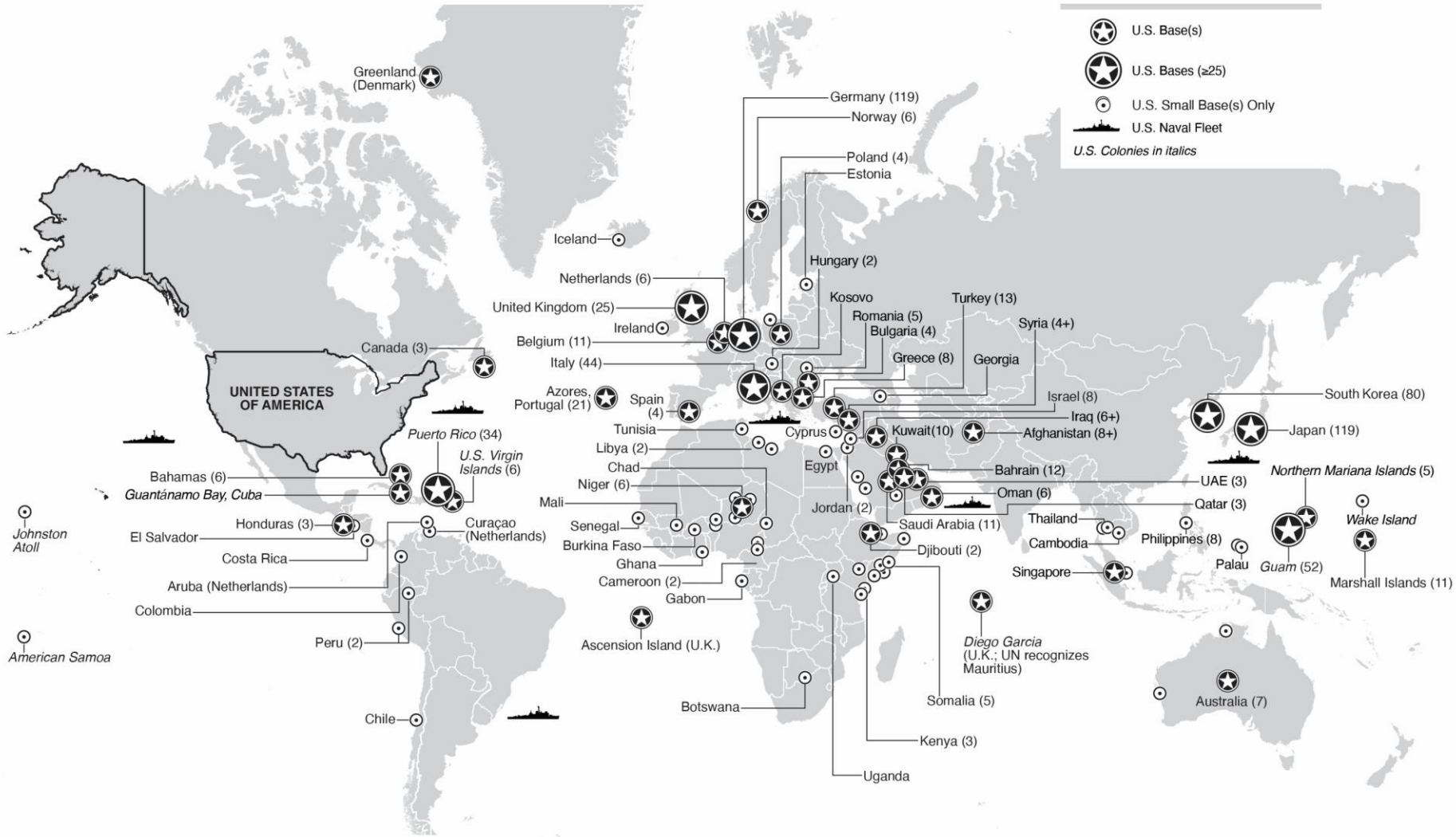
U.S. Military Bases Abroad, 2020

In 2020, the United States controlled around 800 bases outside the 50 U.S. states and Washington, DC. Map reflects bases' relative number and positioning given best available data. For ease of comparison we use contemporary borders and a Mercator projection.



Map by Kelly Martin / kmartindesign.com for David Vine, *The United States of War: A Global History of America's Endless Conflicts, from Columbus to the Islamic State* (University of California Press, 2020).

https://www.basenation.us/uploads/5/7/1/7/57170837/us_military_bases_abroad_map_2020.jpg

Week 6: MENTAL MAPPING

Read:

- **Lynch (pp. 46-91), *Image of the City*.**
- **Gieseking, "Where We Go from Here".**

Mapping practice #3: Mental geographies & mental mapping

“There seems to be a public image of any given city, which is the overlap of many individual images. Or perhaps there is a series of public images, each held by some significant number of citizens. Such group images are necessary if an individual is to operate successfully within their environment and to cooperate with their fellows. Each individual picture is unique, with some content that is rarely or never communicated, yet it approximates the public image…”

Lynch, *Image of the City*

what is a
mental map?

https://www.facebook.com/photo/?fbid=1523847082437328&set=a.610868297068549

what is a mental map?

http://www.buzzfeed.com/tanyachen/americans-fail-canada-again

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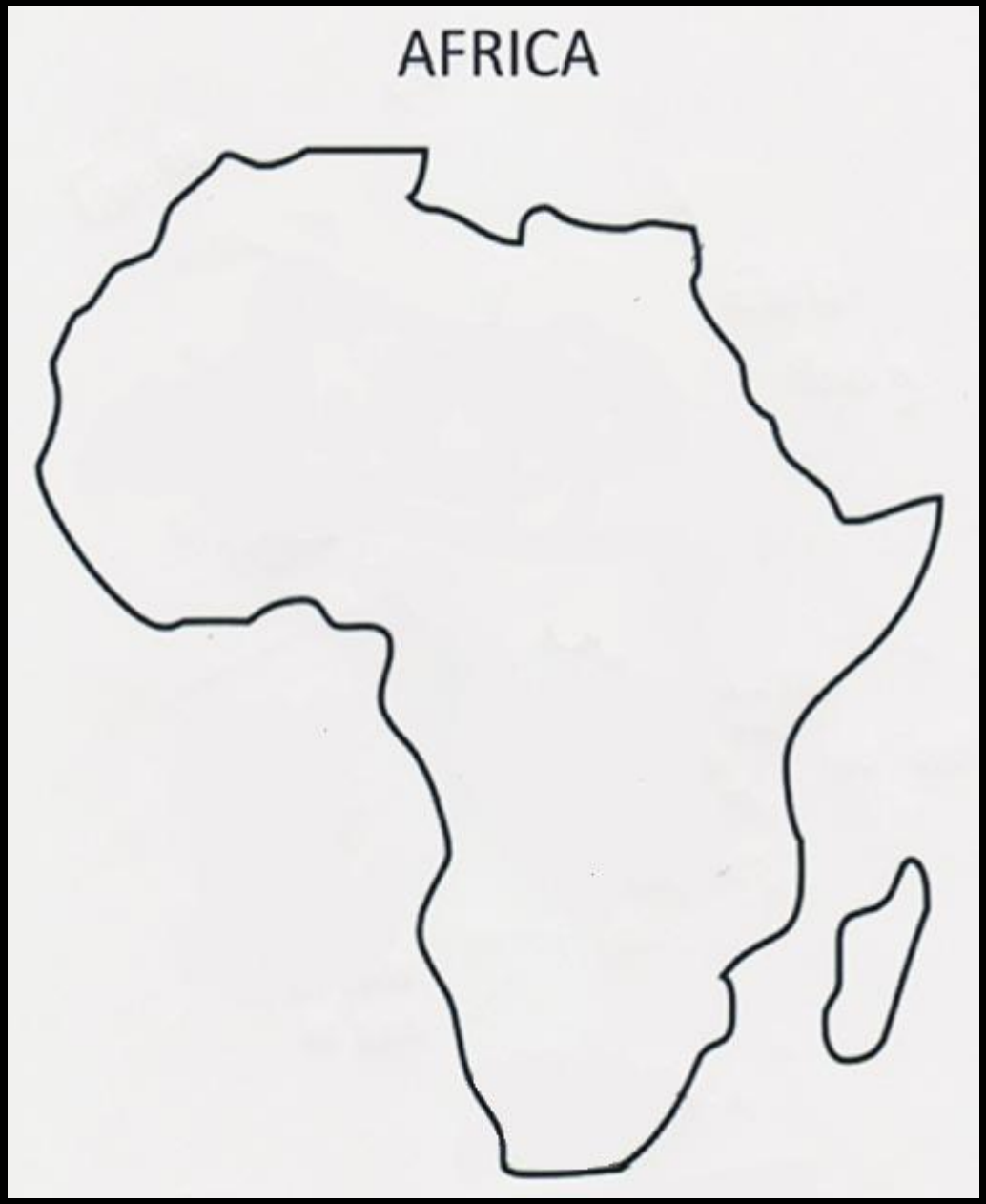
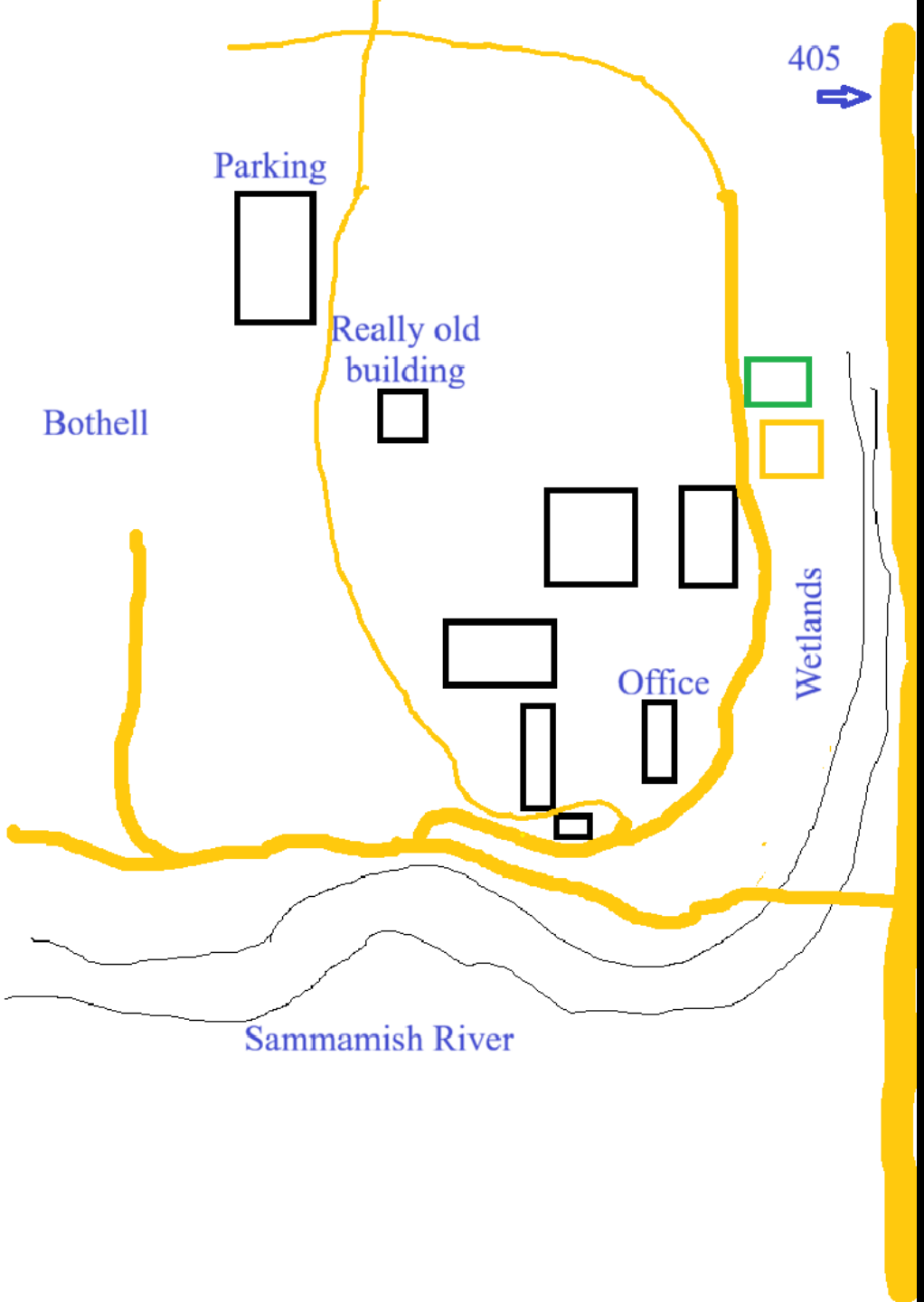


what is a mental map?

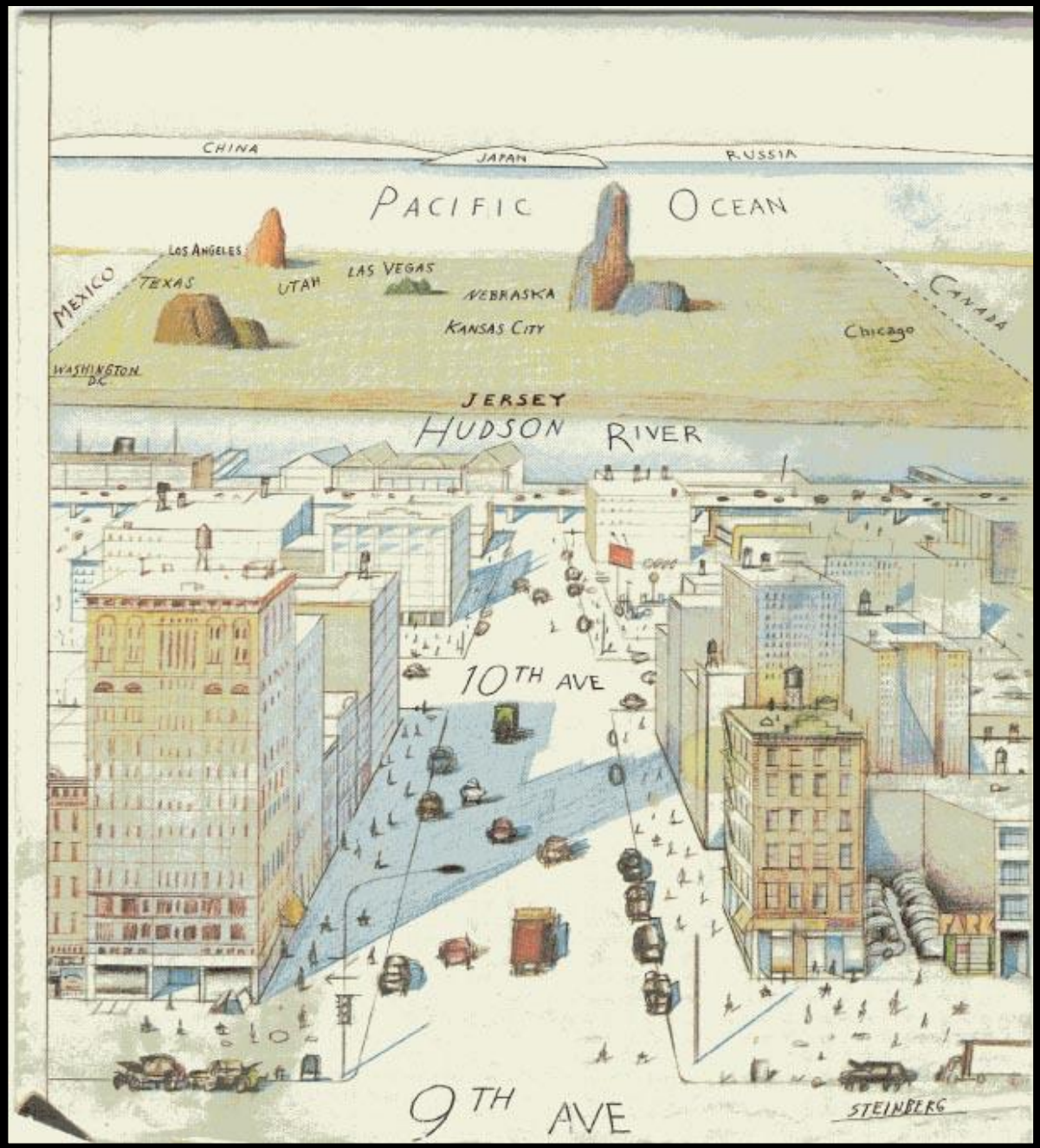
where you think things are



what is a mental map?

where you think things are

your knowledge of surroundings



what is a mental map?

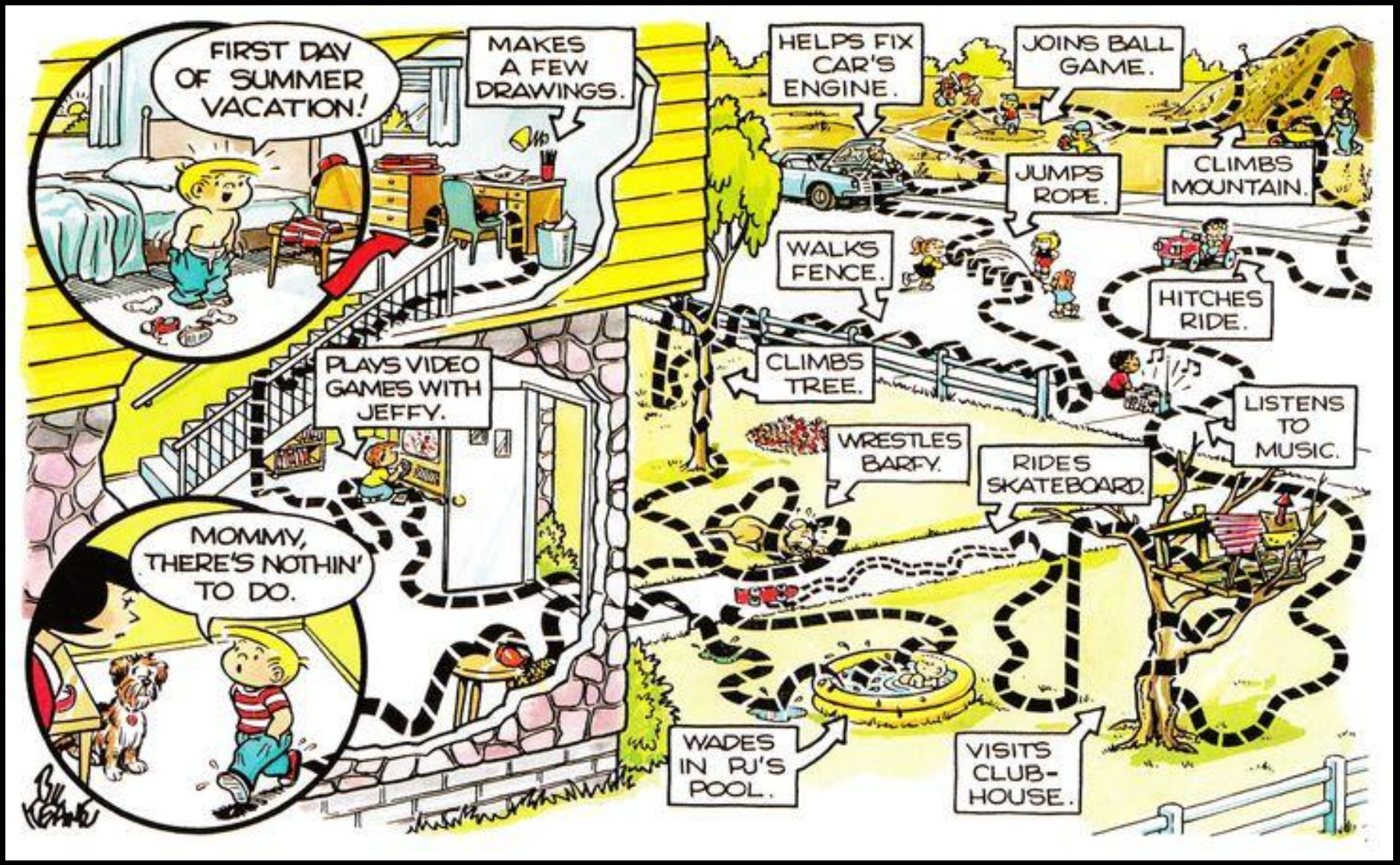
where you think things are

your knowledge of surroundings

your "model" of the world

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/View_of_the_World_from_9th_Avenue

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/American_Progress



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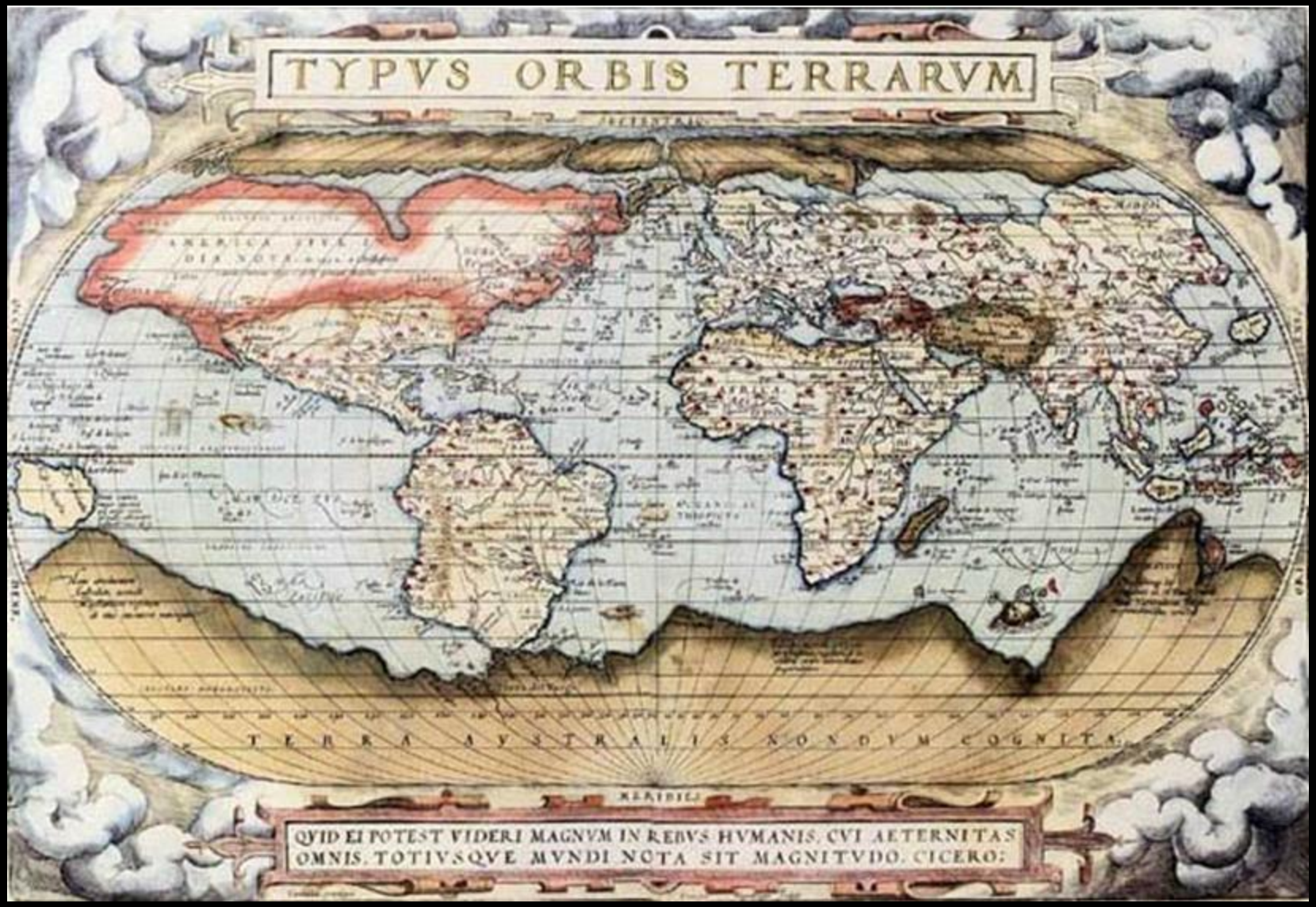
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people use mental maps …

daily routine

directions

world events

https://medium.com/matter/louisiana-loses-its-boot-b55b3bd52d1e

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people use mental maps …

daily routine

directions

world events

collective identity

interpretation

- what info/detail?
- what omitted?
- proportions
- relative placement
- influence of experience
- influence of media
- effect of core, periphery, semi-periphery

https://almatabareh.wordpress.com/2014/10/17/depd-1230-reflection-on-edward-t-halls-the-hidden-dimension/

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PATH

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https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Adansonia_grandidi

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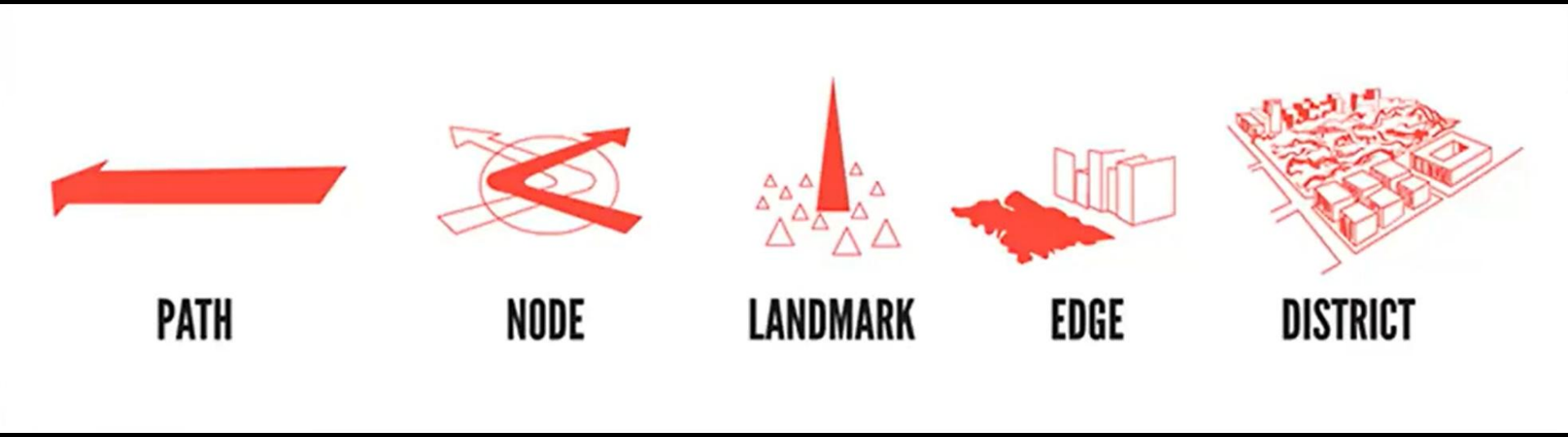

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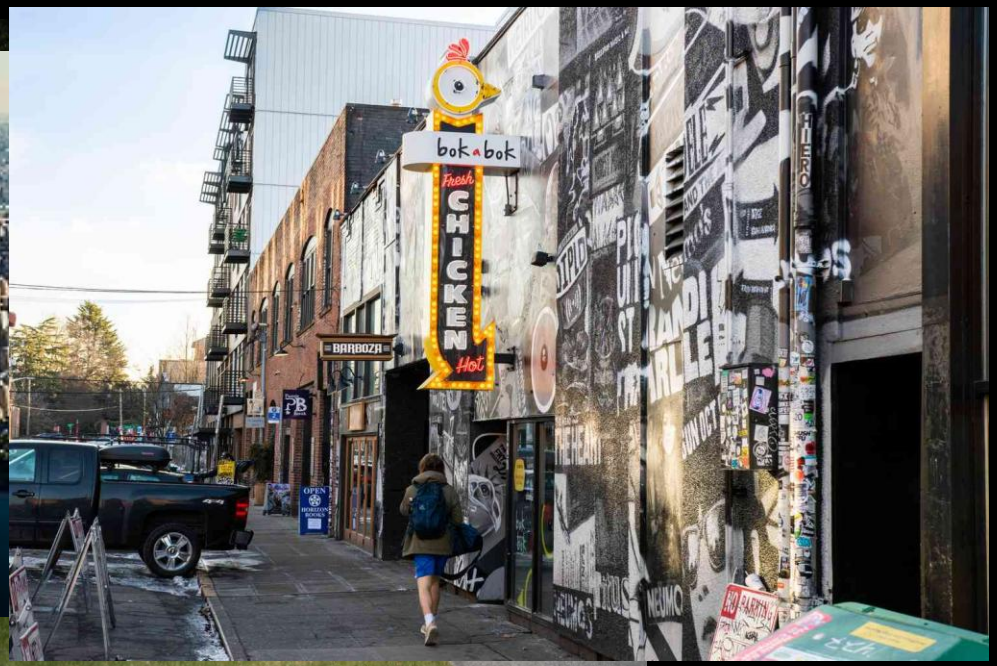
bok a bok
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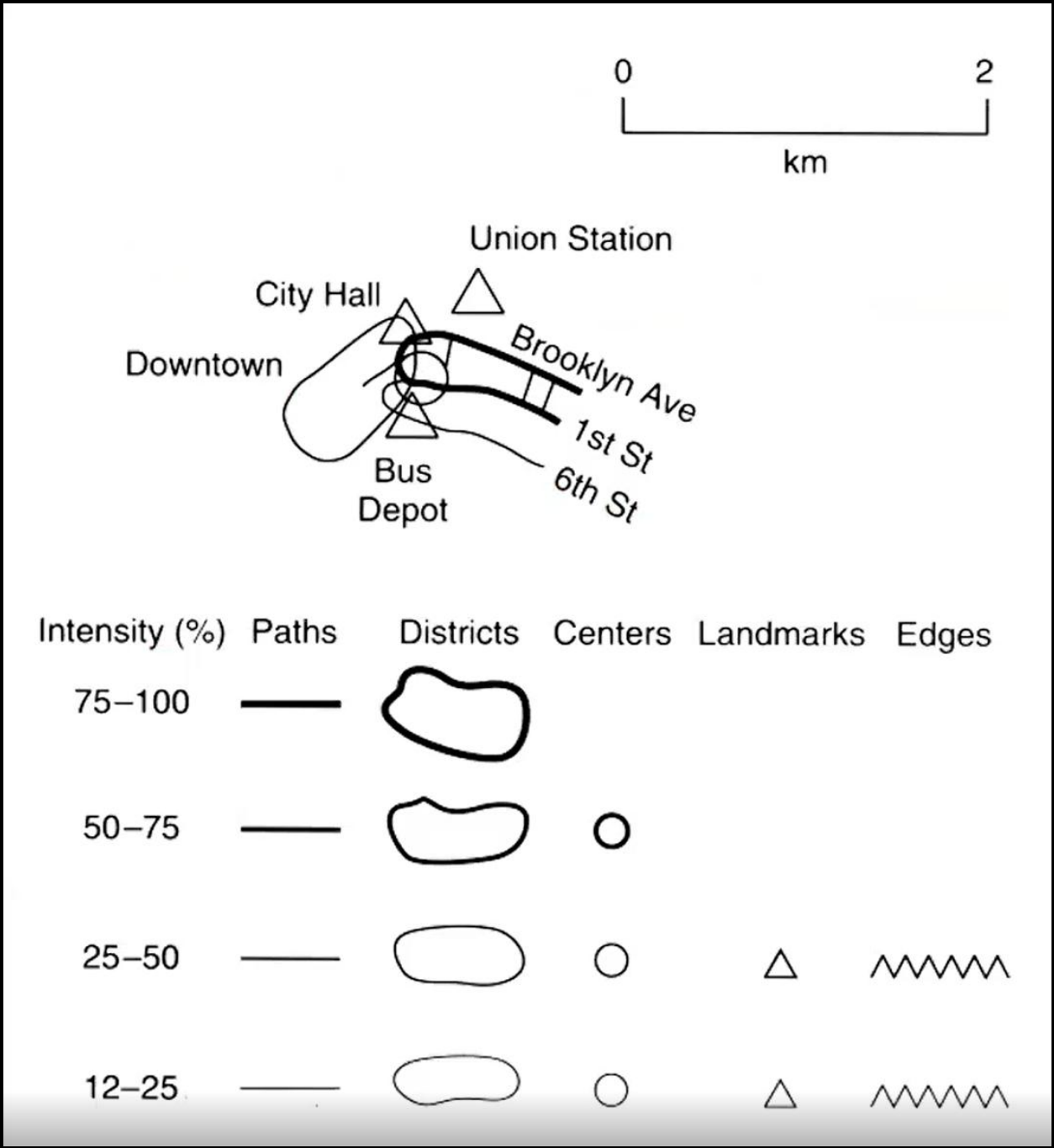
BARBOZA

mental map 1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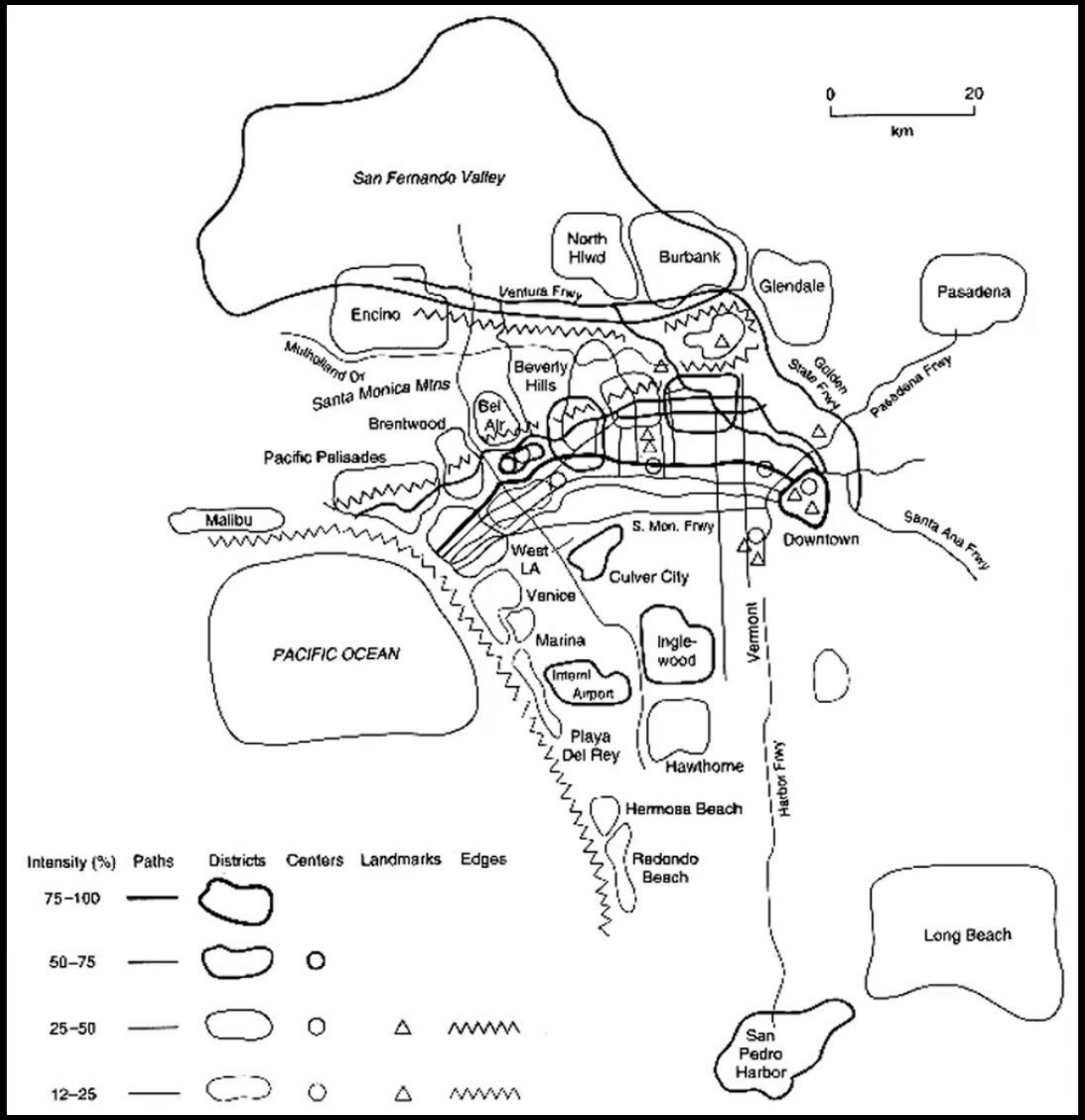
Union Station
City Hall
Downtown
Brooklyn Ave
1st St
6th St
Bus
Depot
Intensity (%)
Paths
Districts
Centers
Landmarks
Edges
75–100
50–75
25–50
12–25

mental map 2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km
San Fernando Valley
North Hlwd
Burbank
Glendale
Pasadena
Ventura Frwy
Encino
Mulholland Dr
Santa Monica Mtns
Beverly Hills
Golden State Frwy
Pasadena Frwy
Bel Air
Brentwood
Pacific Palisades
Malibu
S. Mon. Frwy
Downtown
Santa Ana Frwy
West LA
Culver City
Venice
Marina
PACIFIC OCEAN
Inglewood
Vermont
Intern'l Airport
Playa Del Rey
Hawthorne
Harbor Frwy
Hermosa Beach
Redondo Beach
Long Beach
San Pedro Harbor
Intensity (%)
Paths
Districts
Centers
Landmarks
Edges
75–100
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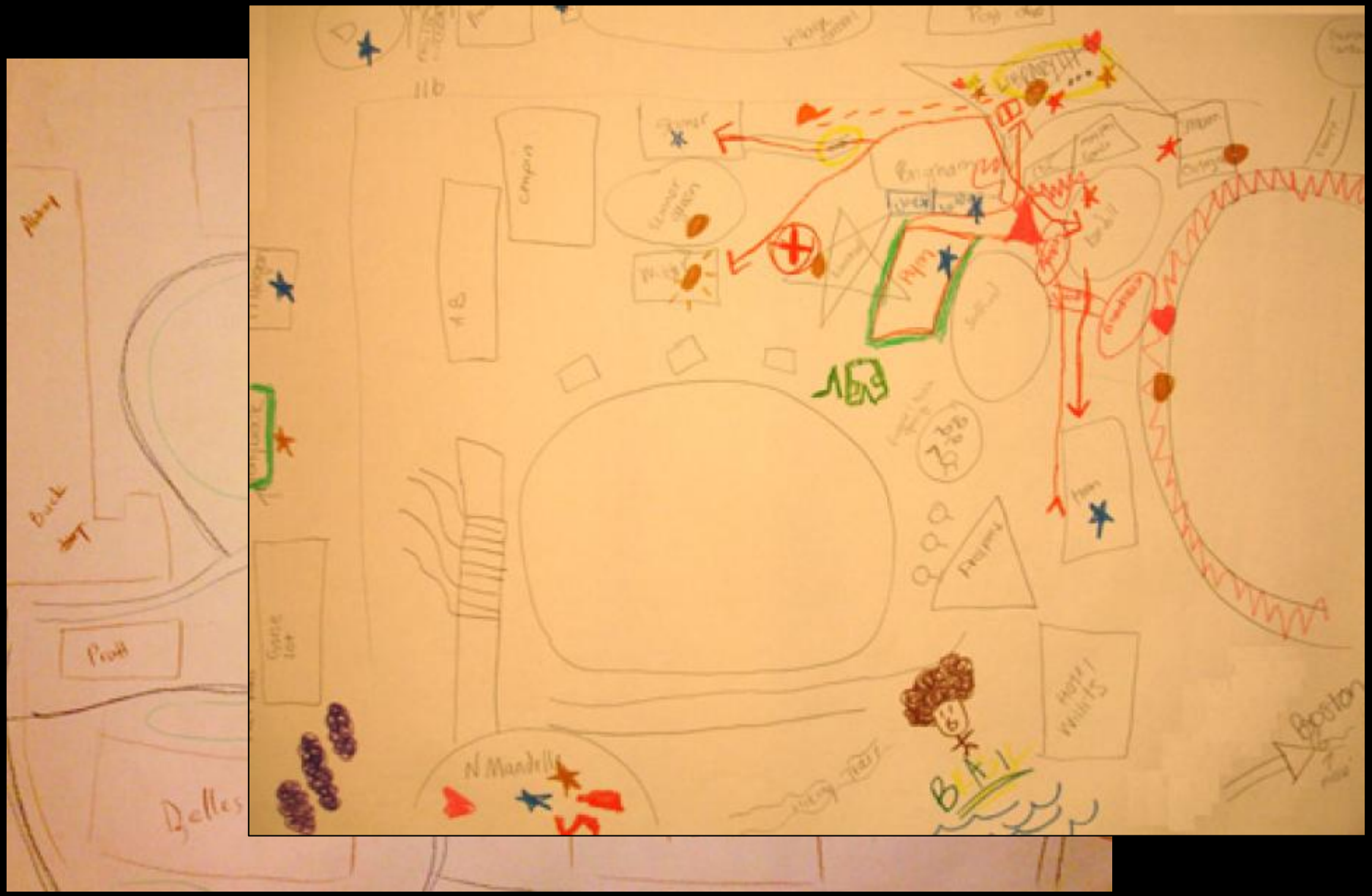
12–25

mental maps 3 & 4

mental maps 3 & 4



HUMANITARIAN OPENSTREETMAP TEAM DATA MODEL

…"would you see any relevance to develop classes for natural (and man-made?) hazards to be included in HOSM framework?"

"…visible on the ground…"

"…average person…"

"top-down information … place-based knowledge systems … counter intuitive to initiatives to 'democratize' data?"

"…my experience with communities… local people know very well where the main hazard zones are located… every year… 'My father told me…"

"…we should aim at a fork-project…"

http://wiki.openstreetmap.org/wiki/OpenHazardMap